B2 Writing

Writing an opinion essay

A four-paragraph plan and linking words for clear, persuasive essays.

An opinion essay states a clear view and supports it with reasons and examples. Examiners look for organisation, linking and a consistent position.

Four-paragraph plan

Paragraph	Content
1. Introduction	Rephrase the question and state your opinion.
2. First reason	Topic sentence, explanation, example.
3. Second reason	Topic sentence, explanation, example. Optionally mention and answer an opposing view.
4. Conclusion	Restate your opinion in new words and summarise the reasons.

Linking words

Function	Expressions
Giving opinion	*In my view, / I strongly believe that / It seems to me that*
Adding	*Furthermore, / In addition, / What is more,*
Contrasting	*However, / Nevertheless, / Although / On the other hand,*
Examples	*For instance, / such as / A good example of this is*
Concluding	*To sum up, / All in all, / In conclusion,*

Keep one position. You can mention the other side, but always explain why your view is stronger.

Practice

1. Join with a contrast word: Cars are convenient. They pollute the air.
2. Rewrite the opinion more formally: I think school uniforms are good.
3. Which paragraph should contain your restated opinion and summary?

▼ Show answers

1. Cars are convenient. However, they pollute the air. / Although cars are convenient, they pollute the air.
2. In my view, school uniforms are beneficial.
3. The conclusion, paragraph 4.